

PROJECT SUTRA — HARIKA'S PITCH SCRIPT

SPEAKER: HARIKA • OPERATIONS LEAD • SLIDES 01 & 02

TOTAL TIME: ~65 SECONDS
STAGE: CENTER STAGE

DELIVERY TIPS FOR HARIKA: Speak clearly, naturally, and with urgent conviction. Maintain confident eye contact with the jury. You set the entire high-stakes mood of the room before handing over to the engineering leads.

SLIDE 01 Opening Hook & Project SUTRA Introduction

00:00 - 00:30 (30s)

[Stand center stage • Take a 1-second pause • Deliver opening hook with serious, grounded tone]

HOOK: "When over 300 lives were buried under mud in the **July 2024 Wayanad landslides**, and flash floods cut off entire mountain valleys across **Kedarnath and Nepal**, rescue teams had only 72 hours to save lives. But the moment standard drones entered thick forests and deep ravines, they lost signal and crashed."

"Respected jury, we are **Team OFFGRID**. I am Harika, and with me are Vedanth and Nikhil. We built **Project SUTRA** — an autonomous drone swarm engineered to find survivors even when **GPS fails and normal communications collapse**."

[Point smoothly toward the 3 cards on Slide 1]

"SUTRA is powered by 3 core breakthroughs:"

PILLAR 1 Self-Flying Swarms: Drones dodge trees and coordinate together at 50 times a second without ground towers. [50Hz GNC]

PILLAR 2 Smart AI Video: Live video stays connected through deep mountain valleys without blacking out. [-5dB JSCC]

PILLAR 3 Thermal & 3D AI Vision: Spots survivors through smoke and finds their exact coordinates on steep slopes. [3D DEM • 3.59cm]

SLIDE 02 The Problem: 4 Real Disaster Breakdowns

00:30 - 01:05 (35s)

[Click to Slide 2 • Transition tone to urgent, factual investigation]

THE VOD: "When our team audited actual NDRF and Army rescue reports from recent disaster zones, we found 4 major breakdowns:"

BREAKDOWN 1 Trees Block GPS: In Wayanad, thick tree cover blocked satellite signals, causing **70% of drones to crash into branches**.

BREAKDOWN 2 Mountains Block Radio: In mountain gorges, steep ridges blocked radio signals, dropping video feeds to total black.

BREAKDOWN 3 Slope Errors: On steep 45-degree hillsides, standard drone cameras assumed flat ground, **missing survivor locations by 15 to 30 meters**.

BREAKDOWN 4 Pilot Overload: Deploying 5 separate drones required **15 to 25 crew members** and 2 hours of setup, costing ₹12.5 Lakhs per flight.

POWER HANDOFF TO VEDANTH:

"Vedanth will now explain how our AI vision and tactical ground control solve these bottlenecks."